

Leila, Haj Abdullah Alieh

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14/03/1988
Nationality_Italian



Curious neuroscientist with a passion for brain development and cognitive functions.
Core skills: transcriptome analysis * *in utero* electroporation * molecular biology

Education

03/2015-present	PhD, Dresden International PhD Program (DIPP) Center for Regenerative Therapies Dresden (CRTD) Technische Universität Dresden, Germany
09/2011-03/2014	International Master Degree in Neuroscience International School for Advanced Studies (ISAS) University of Trieste, Italy. 110/110 cum laude (first class honours)
10/2007-09/2011	Bachelor Degree in Biology_Biomolecular curriculum University of Trieste, Italy. 110/110 cum laude (first class honours)

Teaching Experience

09/2019-present	Reviewer for STAR Protocols-Cell Press
05/2019-present	Speaker in remote seminars for students worldwide with the association "Skype a Scientist"
06/2018-present	Supervision of early stages PhD students
09/2017-09/2017	Supervision of master students during training lab-rotations

Research Experience

03/2015-present	PhD candidate_ Dresden International PhD Program (DIPP) While differential <i>gene</i> expression has long been known to regulate differentiation, in this project I investigated whether changes in <i>transcripts</i> representation by alternative splicing could influence cell-fate commitment during neocortical development. I characterized the splicing profiles of cells of the neurogenic lineage at consecutive stages of differentiation in order to identify splicing events and specific isoforms that govern the neurogenic commitment in physiological conditions. To gain insight into isoform-specific functions in shaping the neocortical development, I manipulated selected splice variants <i>in</i>
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	<i>in vivo</i> by in utero electroporation in the embryonic mouse lateral cortex. Supervisor: Dr. Federico Calegari
10/2014-03/2015	Da Vinci Program_ Babraham Institute, Cambridge, UK I investigated the role of non-coding DNA in heterochromatin formation and in stem cell differentiation. Supervisor: Dr. Jon Houseley
01/2013-08/2013	Erasmus Program_ Neuroscience Center, Helsinki, Finland Master internship. I conducted research about antidepressant-induced neural plasticity, in the context of addiction treatment. Supervisors: Dr. Eero Castrén, Dr. Nina N. Karpova
01/2011-07/2011	University of Trieste, Italy Bachelor internship. I learned basis of electroencephalography (EEG) and of brain-computer Interface (BCI). Supervisors: Dr. Piero Paolo Battaglini, Dr. Joanna Jarmolowska

Technical Skills

Wet-lab	• DNA and RNA extraction • PCR; qRT-PCR; RT-PCR • Enzymatic digestion • Western blot chemiluminescent and fluorescent quantitative • Native and denaturing PAGE gels • Northern blot and southern blot with radioactive probes • Gene and isoform cloning • Free-floating and on frozen sections immunohistochemistry • Cell culture with standard cell lines • Primary neuronal cell culture • Differentiation of ES cells into embryoid bodies • Cell transfection with PEI and with lipofectamine methods • In utero electroporation in mouse embryo brains • Embryonic brain and neocortex dissection, cryopreservation, embedding and cryostat sectioning • Neuronal cell dissociation for FAC-sorting • Confocal microscopy
Computational	• Transcriptome sequencing data alignment • Coding skills with R, Perl and bash languages • Bioinformatic tools of the Bioconductor software project and with alternative splicing-specific tools
Certificates	FELASA B Category Certificate Rat and Mouse species modules

Honours and Awards

2017	Dresden International Graduate School for Biomedicine and Bioengineering (DIGS-BB) Fellowship The fellowship honors outstanding PhD students of the Dresden International PhD Program including salary and personal budget for consumables for the whole duration of the PhD.
2014	Thesis award "Premio di Studio Bruno Maestro" Award for outstanding research in the field of addiction treatment.
2014	Unipharma Graduates 10_Leonardo Da Vinci Program Selective internship program for Master students from Italy.

Publications

(2020)	Alieh, LHA et al. Role of alternative splicing in neurogenic commitment (in preparation)
2020	Dori, M., Cavalli, D., Lesche, M., Massalini, S., Alieh, LHA ; Cardoso de Toledo, B.; Khudayberdiev, S.; Schratt, G.; Calegari, F (2020). microRNA profiling of mouse cortical progenitors and neurons reveals miR-486-5p as a novel regulator of neurogenesis. Development
2019	Dori, M., Alieh, LHA. , Cavalli, D., Massalini, S., Lesche, M., Dahl, A., Calegari, F. (2019). Sequence and Expression Levels of Circular-RNAs in Progenitor Cell Types During Mouse Corticogenesis. Life Science Alliance

Presentations and Events

03/2019	Talk. Invited speaker at the <i>PhD Seminar Series, CRTD</i> , Dresden, Germany
05/2018	Talk. Invited speaker at the <i>Biopolis Symposium</i> , Dresden, Germany
09/2017	Poster. <i>Gene regulatory mechanisms in neural fate decisions EMBO Conference</i> , Alicante, Spain
09/2016	Poster and Talk. <i>First International Conference on Splicing</i> , Caparica, Portugal
02/2016	Poster. <i>ISSCR – Stem Cell Models of Neural Regeneration and Disease</i> , Dresden, Germany
05/2015	Poster. <i>Abcam – Adult Neurogenesis: Evolution, Regulation and Function</i> ,

Dresden, Germany

- 11/2011 Seminar *The Neurofeedback* at Liceo Scientifico Galileo Galilei (High school of scientific studies)
Trieste, Italy
- 09/2011 Event for non-academic public_ *European Researcher's night*
Trieste, Italy

Competences

Linguistic	Italian Mother tongue English Fluent	French Intermediate German Beginner
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Interests and hobbies

In my free time I like to do sports, mainly running and bouldering. I enjoy reading, watching movies, play piano and knitting. In the past I have been involved in human right campaign as a volunteer for Amnesty International.